Q M R G
Quantitative
Methods
Research Group

QMRG annual report

2025-26

15 September 2026

QMRG committee, September 2026: Francisco Rowe (Chair); Weiming Huang (Secretary); Alessia Calafiore (Treasurer); Trivik Verma (Diversity and Inclusion Officer); Stephen Law (Conferences Officer); Bardia Mashhoodi (Dissertation Prize Officer); Elisabetta Pietrostefani and Ruth Neville (Social Media/Web Officers); Matt Mason and Fangyuan Li (Postgraduate Representatives).

Summary

During 2025-26, QMRG renewed two committee roles, secured workshop funding, recognised research and undergraduate dissertations through prizes, and organised and sponsored sessions at the RGS-IBG Annual International Conference. The group also held an evening social to support informal networking across the quantitative human geography community.

Staffing

Yijing Li and Qunshan Zhao stepped down from the committee. Weiming Huang succeeded Qunshan as Secretary, and Bardia Mashhoodi succeeded Yijing as Dissertation Prize Officer. Alessia Calafiore and Elisabetta Pietrostefani returned from maternity leave and resumed their committee roles.

Committee succession will be staggered over the coming year. Alessia Calafiore, Elisabetta Pietrostefani and Stephen Law expect to serve for one further year before stepping down. QMRG will announce calls for replacements for Postgraduate Representatives Matt Mason and Fangyuan Li.

Grant activity

QMRG was awarded funding for a grant led by Dr Weiming Huang in collaboration with Prof. Francisco Rowe to host a workshop on Geospatial Foundational Models at the University of Leeds in October 2025.

Prizes

QMRG nominated Dr Filip Biljecki, who received the 2026 Gill Memorial Award (human).

QMRG awarded its 2025 undergraduate dissertation prize to two winners.

Sponsorship

QMRG organised and sponsored the following sessions at the RGS-IBG Annual International Conference, held on 2-4 September 2026. The programme covered spatial inequality, geospatial artificial intelligence, early-career research and methodological questions about geographical data.

- **Wednesday 2 September:** Mapping Inequality Critically; Geospatial Artificial Intelligence methods and applications (1); Geospatial Artificial Intelligence methods and applications (2): Workshop.
- **Thursday 3 September:** QMRG Early Career Session (1); QMRG Early Career Session (2); QMRG Annual Lecture in collaboration with *The Geographical Journal*.
- **Friday 4 September:** No Space Like Home? Space inequalities, property development and urban injustice (1); Gender Inequalities: What Geography Data Can (and Cannot) Tell Us; No Space Like Home? Space inequalities, property development and urban injustice (2); Inequalities from Space.

At the annual lecture, Jessica Espey spoke on “Whose Numbers Count? The Contested Politics of Data in National Policy and Planning”.

Networking

QMRG organised an evening social at The Hoop & Toy in Kensington on Thursday 3 September 2026, following the annual lecture. Held alongside the RGS-IBG conference, the event brought together the quantitative human geography community for informal networking and community building.